

Phishing Email Investigation — Header Analysis & Threat Intel

End-to-end investigation of a suspicious `.eml` phishing sample: email authentication analysis (SPF/DKIM/DMARC), IOC extraction, and threat intelligence verification.

Tools: CyberChef , AbuseIPDB , VirusTotal , [URLScan.io](https://urlscan.io)

Overview :

Objective: Verify sender authenticity and identify spoofing in a suspected phishing email

Sample : sample-10.eml

Verdict: Confirmed Phishing

1. Email Header Analysis

Reviewed the raw `.eml` headers to trace routing and verify authentication.

Authentication Results:

Mechanism	Result
SPF	None
DKIM	None
DMARC	None

```
3 Transport; Fri, 8 Sep 2023 05:47:04 +0000
4 Authentication-Results: spf=none (sender IP is 89.144.44.2)
5 smtp.mailfrom=thcultarfdes.co.uk; dkim=none (message not signed)
6 header.d=none;dmARC=permerror action=none header.from=access-accsecurity.com;
```

Spoofing check: Microsoft account team , `<no-reply@access-accsecurity.com>` **vs actual return-path** `bounce@thcultarfdes.co.uk` — The domain in the display address is **access-xykty.com**, but the domain in the actual return path is **thcultarfdes.co.uk**. Since the two differ, **spoofing** is confirmed.

Received header chain (origin → delivery):

1: [hop 1 IP/hostname] -

thcultarfdes.co.uk (89.144.44.2)

2:[hop 2 IP/hostname] -

DB8EUR06FT032.mail.protection.outlook.com

3:[final delivery server] -

SJ0PR19MB6679.namprd19.prod.outlook.com /
MN0PR19MB6312.namprd19.prod.outlook.com

2. IOC Extraction Table Details :

Type	Indicator	Notes
URL	http://thebandalisty.com/track/o43062rdzGz18708448Gdrw1821750fYo33632dSjh176	Hidden tracking phishing link in tag
IP	89[.]144[.]44[.]2	Originating mail server ip(Header Line 14/19)
HASH(SHA256)	N/A	No attachment present in this email

```
<td id="114" style="padding: 0px; font-family: 'Segoe UI', Tahoma, Verdana, Arial, sans-serif; font-size: 14px; color: #242424; height: 18px; width: 696px;
</tr>

</tbody>
</table>
<style type="text/css">@media h326
```

3. Threat Intelligence Verification

AbuseIPDB – sending IP reputation:

Field	Result
IP	89.144.44.2
Abuse Confidence	0%
Report	0

AbuseIPDB » 89.144.44.2

Check an IP Address, Domain Name, Subnet, or ASN
e.g. 2409:40d0:2488:283e:40e3:e6e5:ed:a9b9, microsoft.com,
5.188.10.0/24, or AS15169

89.144.44.2

89.144.44.2 was not found in our database

This IP was reported **0** times. Confidence of Abuse is **0%**:

?

0%

ISP	MSCode.pl
Usage Type	Fixed Line ISP
ASN	AS201132
Hostname(s)	r2.mscode.pl
Domain Name	mscode.pl
Country	 Poland
City	Warsaw, Mazovia

VirusTotal – URL/hash detections:

Indicator	Detections
http://thebandalisty.com/track/o43062rdzGz18708448Gdrw1821750fYo33632dSjh176	[10]/92 engines

10

/ 92

Community Score

URL report for 2025-06-17 19:04:54 UTC.

ReanalyzeMore

http://thebandalisty.com/track/o43062rdrGz18708448Gdrw1821750fo33632d5jh176

thebandalisty.com

StatusContent TypeLast Analysis Date1 month ago

SUMMARYDETECTIONDETAILSCOMMUNITY

Security vendors' analysis

ADMINUSLabs	Malicious	alphaMountain.ai	Phishing
BitDefender	Phishing	CRDF	Malicious
CyRadar	Phishing	Fortinet	Phishing
G-Data	Phishing	Lionic	Phishing
Sophos	Phishing	Webroot	Malicious

10

/ 92

Community Score

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thebandalisty.com

StatusContent TypeLast Analysis Date1 month ago

SUMMARYDETECTIONDETAILSCOMMUNITY

Page Stats

Network Requests0

HTTPS Requests0%

Domains0

IP Addresses0

IPv6 Addresses0%

Countries0

Response Size0B

Cookies0

URL Overview

Vendors Analysis:

10/92 security vendors flagged this URL as malicious

Final URL:

http://thebandalisty.com/track/o43062rdrGz18708448Gdrw1821750fo33632d5jh176

Domain:

thebandalisty.com

Serving IP:

-

Current Status Code:

Error ()

Category:

Phishing (alphaMountain.ai) parked phishing and fraud Phishing and Other Frauds information technology

4. Conclusion

The email is a confirmed phishing attempt impersonating Microsoft account security, utilizing domain spoofing (From header mismatched with Return-Path domain thcultarfdes.co.uk). It contains an embedded 1x1 pixel hidden tracking link (thebandalisty.com) designed to monitor user engagement or redirect users to potential credential harvesting lures.